

Problem 2

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Problem 1 For each of the following functions find an equation of the tangent line at the given point.

(a) $f(x) = -5x^2 + 7x - 9$ at $x = 3$.

Explanation. The slope of tangent line is given by this limit: $f'(3) = \lim_{x \rightarrow 3} \frac{f(x) - f(3)}{x - 3}$. Notice that this limit has form $\frac{0}{0}$, so it is indeterminate.

$$\begin{aligned} f'(3) &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 3} \frac{f(x) - f(3)}{x - 3} = \lim_{x \rightarrow 3} \frac{(-5x^2 + 7x - 9) - (-45 + 21 - 9)}{x - 3} \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 3} \frac{-5x^2 + 7x - 9 + 33}{x - 3} \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 3} \frac{-5x^2 + 7x + 24}{x - 3} \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 3} \frac{(x - 3)(-5x - 8)}{x - 3} \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 3} (-5x - 8) \\ &= -5(3) - 8 = -23. \end{aligned}$$

Point on tangent line: $(3, f(3)) = (3, -33)$.

An equation of tangent line is:

$$y + 33 = -23(x - 3)$$

(b) $g(u) = \sqrt{5u - 4}$ at $u = 3$.

Explanation. The slope of tangent line is given by: $g'(3) = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{g(3+h) - g(3)}{h}$.

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Notice that this limit has form $\frac{0}{0}$, so it is indeterminate.

$$\begin{aligned}
 g'(3) &= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{g(3+h) - g(3)}{h} = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\sqrt{5(3+h) - 4} - \sqrt{11}}{h} \\
 &= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\sqrt{5(3+h) - 4} - \sqrt{11}}{h} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{5(3+h) - 4} + \sqrt{11}}{\sqrt{5(3+h) - 4} + \sqrt{11}} \\
 &= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{5(3+h) - 4 - 11}{h \left(\sqrt{5(3+h) - 4} + \sqrt{11} \right)} \\
 &= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{5h + 15 - 15}{h \left(\sqrt{5(3+h) - 4} + \sqrt{11} \right)} \\
 &= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{5}{\left(\sqrt{5(3+h) - 4} + \sqrt{11} \right)} \\
 &= \frac{5}{\sqrt{5(3+0) - 4} + \sqrt{11}} \\
 &= \frac{5}{2\sqrt{11}}.
 \end{aligned}$$

Point on tangent line: $(3, g(3)) = (3, \sqrt{11})$.

Equation of tangent line:

$$y - \sqrt{11} = \frac{5}{2\sqrt{11}}(u - 3)$$

(c) $s(z) = \frac{z}{z-5}$ at $z = 3$.

Explanation. The slope of tangent line is given by: $s'(3) = \lim_{z \rightarrow 3} \frac{s(z) - s(3)}{z - 3}$.

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Notice that this limit has form $\frac{0}{0}$, so it is indeterminate.

$$\begin{aligned}s'(3) &= \lim_{z \rightarrow 3} \frac{s(z) - s(3)}{z - 3} \\&= \lim_{z \rightarrow 3} \frac{\frac{z}{z-5} - \frac{3}{3-5}}{z - 3} \\&= \lim_{z \rightarrow 3} \frac{\frac{z}{z-5} + \frac{3}{2}}{z - 3} \\&= \lim_{z \rightarrow 3} \frac{\frac{2z}{2(z-5)} + \frac{3(z-5)}{2(z-5)}}{z - 3} \\&= \lim_{z \rightarrow 3} \frac{\frac{2z+3z-15}{2(z-5)}}{z - 3} \\&= \lim_{z \rightarrow 3} \frac{5z - 15}{2(z - 5)} \cdot \frac{1}{z - 3} \\&= \lim_{z \rightarrow 3} \frac{5(z - 3)}{2(z - 5)} \cdot \frac{1}{z - 3} \\&= \lim_{z \rightarrow 3} \frac{5}{2(z - 5)} \\&= \frac{5}{2(3 - 5)} = -\frac{5}{4}.\end{aligned}$$

Point on tangent line: $(3, s(3)) = (3, -3/2)$.

Equation of tangent line:

$$y + \frac{3}{2} = -\frac{5}{4}(z - 3)$$